

Blue Water Navy Q&A from BGG (May 2020):

This document was compiled with questions from Boardgamegeek and Consimworld's Blue Water Navy thread. I usually pulled all answers directly from the designer Stuart Tonge. I have added a few general questions he answered at the end. Changes since the last V1.1 are in red.

General questions about moving:

TF in weather, SHIPS happens so it should move but doesn't due to weather - it just gets a "moving" marker instead. Does this count as a move for triggering detection/attack by an on patrol MP/sub?

Similarly does marking a TF with a "landing" marker count as a move for this purpose?

What about ASW?

What about declining to move the TF when it gets the chance?

No, and on patrol only triggers when you move into an area or through it - in this case you're already there.

A SSBN/SSN stack moving spends 1 OPS?

yes, 1 ops to move both

16.2 says a moving Soviet SSBN may take a non-diesel submarine with it for no extra cost. Must the two subs start together in the same zone or port, or can the Boomer pick up the sub as it moves?

The subs have to start together (mid-sea rendezvous is VERY hard)

Per rule 11.0, do convoys have to be detached during the ships event to enter port at a cost of 1 OPS point if the remainder of the TF stays at sea?

No cost, they just detach for free and enter port.

When you create a new TF ... Can you put more than one convoy counter?

Yes as many as you like

If a submarine is part of a task force, is there a way for it to remove itself from the TF, besides dissolving the TF?

Yes, just activate it normally for whatever it wants to do, place it on the board in the same position as the task force it's leaving and off it goes..

Air units and rules:

CAP generic definitions (SUPER IMPORTANT!):

I find mentions of CAP in the rulebook, but cannot locate anything that tells me how to put fighters on CAP. Am I to assume that carrier based fighters that are not spent are always on CAP?

All FTR are on CAP all the time in effect - you don't need to spend actions/ OPS.

And, if my carrier with fresh fighters enters a sea zone that contains enemy MPs do my fighters automatically attack them and are then marked spent? Or would this cost an action?

if your carrier enters a new sea zone and enemy MP are on patrol, the MP may activate to try to detect you at which point you can try to shoot them down. CAP is never spent by resolving combat.

Spent MPs:

Do patrolling maritime patrols become spent if they are present and contribute their dice fore defense against a sub attack on surface ships?

No, they just keep on flying

I understand that MP's that are On Patrol, go Spent if they make an attack (or detection roll) triggered by a moving sub or TF. Likewise an on patrol sub goes spent if it attacks.

I had assumed that an on Patrol Fighter that intercepted would also be spent - but I don't actually see this in the rules - do they go spent or remain on patrol?

They remain on patrol

Stacking of MPs:

If multiple maritime patrols are in an area, and a submarine attacks a TF, do the MP's ASW values stack?

yes

Air to Air values of on-map fighters:

What are the Air to Air values of the Danish F16 and Turkish F4 printed on the map? Unlike the US F15s printed on the map, those two are missing the Air to Air values.

Variable according to Invasion tracks (20.0).

Movement of air units and CAP:

An air unit enters a sea zone with a land facility adjacent to the zone and a TF with a carrier. It doesn't attack the facility : the facility CAP doesn't react ?

Correct

The carrier CAP reacts even if the air unit doesn't attack the TF ? If there are 2 TF with carrier, all carrier fighters may react at once against this air unit ?

f the air unit in question does something (like searches or attacks) then yes the CAP will attack.

The limitations on how many CAP can fight are given in the relevant rules sections (17.x)

If the air unit attacks the land facility, the carrier CAP reacts first and the facility CAP reacts after ?

No all CAP is simultaneous, there is only one 'CAP defence' so you just have to work out which CAP will involve itself and resolve it.

So if an air unit just pass through the sea zone, there is no CAP reaction ?

Correct in this case, because CAP reaction has not been triggered (17.2) though interception would be triggered (17.3)

(from QRS):

Air Units Intercepted when:

- Entering a zone with a Fighter unit on patrol
- **Leaving a zone with an enemy carrier**
- Overflying Denmark or Turkey. The War Track fighter symbols show the number of dice to roll.

About 17.3 rules:

Example: red strike air units in North 5-6 attack UK airfield. There are US CV in East 4 (so adjacent to UK airfield).

Are F-14 CAPs allowed to attack strike air units? Strictly speaking, 17.3 says yes but in this case (not in the good zone), it seems very strange.

17.3: CAP - No sea-based CAP can only help if the strike flies through their zone or attacks from their zone, though I can see how the wording might be a bit confusing.

Here is a proposed rewording:

17.3 CAP may roll to attack when: • A strike attacks a location being protected: "Carrier based fighters defend every Task Force in the Sea Zone and every land facility adjacent to the zone (the carrier does not have to be a target). **The STK must occupy the carrier's sea zone for the carrier to take part in CAP.**

Example of Play (page 53) and QRS return MP to base for Lightly damaged Airbase. But Damage Effect Table on page 12 returns to base only Fighter Units.

I think effect on Fighter and MP is correct because of *No Air Units may fly* commentary. Could anyone confirm it ?

GAH!. Another silly errata. Yes it RTB's MP units as well.
The runway is closed to all but emergency CAP effectively.

Can 2 FTR (different sides) be on patrol in the same zone? If yes, what is the procedure if a strike group enters the zone? (intercepting interceptors..)

you mean one soviet and one NATO?

If so, they will fight as soon as they are present together but that might not be decisive in which case they sit looking at one another for awhile, fighting again at the end of the turn

(i'd need to check the turn sequence) but if a strike enters, the non-strike player is allowed to use his interceptor to try and attack the strike as per standard intercept rules.

Example of real life with Nimrods on Patrol:

NATO has the range 2 Nimrod 'On Patrol' in the Barents Sea. The Soviets form a TF at port (Kola). Can the Nimrod react and attempt to detect the TF (and the Kiev's fighter would get a CAP attack first) in port? If the Nimrod doesn't/can't attempt detection, would there be any interaction between it and the Kiev's fighters (still in port)?

Same situation, a 'Ships' event occurs and the Soviet TF leaves port, moving into the Barents Sea. Can the Nimrod react to detect the TF? If the Nimrod doesn't react, is there any interaction between it and the Kiev's CAP?

Now once at sea, the TF's CAP protects the sea zone and all adjacent land facilities, so if the Soviets move a sub out of the Bastion and into the Barents, the Nimrod can react to conduct ASW, but the TF CAP gets to attack the Nimrod first, got that (I think).

The Nimrod can't do anything & vice versa until the TF leaves port.

When the TF leaves, the Nimrod can react to try and place a detection, and Kiev's CAP can try to shoot it down first.

Yes on the last bullet (paragraph).

Copy, but if the Nimrod doesn't attempt detection on the TF can the Kiev's CAP do anything?

The Nimrod stands off until you activate it.

The CAP could only effect it thereafter.

To shift it before that you need an interceptor (or just ignore it - it's not hurting you... yet)

With Steve's Example of Nimrod and Soviet CV in Barents Sea, Nimrod can't be attacked by Yak-38 because it is in CAP Mission (by default) and not in Interception (first bullet) but could be intercepted if it leaves the Barents Sea Zone ?

If the carrier is at sea, the CAP will get a chance to shoot the Nimrod before it performs a mission.

If the carrier is not at sea, it's CAP can do nothing but likewise the task force cannot be detected.

If the carrier is at sea, and the Nimrod decides to leave the zone - yes - interception would apply. (it's a slightly odd edge-case, and not what the rule was intended for but it's not a big deal)

F-14s:

When all the steps of F-14 are lost the CV runs out of F-14?

Yes

I understand that in reality the US NAVY does not send all the F-14 to escort, only some because others are left to defend the fleet.

That's true but if less than 10 then they do not have enough to do much - some are in maintenance, some are refuelling, and so on - a squadron of fighters is quickly overwhelmed with all the tasks

If they are all shot down? the CV is left without F-14 defense. this implies that they will not possess more fighters in the whole game, I know that by cards can have reinforcements. but a waste of CV without F-14.

Maybe, the CV still has CAG strike and can do a lot of damage by bombing

Is there any other way to retrieve F-14 from the CV than by cards?

No, only the cards can reinforce the carriers

Interceptions sequencing:

When multiple interruptions occur at the same time, which one takes precedence. E.g. Task Force triggering several on patrol units when entering a sea zone with enemy sub, MP, fighter...thanks

Only one on-patrol unit can react to each enemy that 'triggers' interception.

1)

USN Carrier in the Norwegian Sea

2 Phantoms in the UK airbases

2 Badgers attack the airbases....

Is the resolution:

- The F14 CAP attacks the strike (rolling vs one Badger) "before it gets to complete its mission" - does this count as an interception or CAP?**
- then both Phantoms act as CAP for the base?**

Or can the F14 act as CAP for the base too? (as it is better than a Phantom)? Or can it not because it has already intercepted?

The F-14 only intercepts if the strike *leaves* the sea zone - assuming they have not, there is no interception.

The CAP can be chosen from among the airbase CAP and the carrier CAP as long as the strike attacks from the zone containing the carrier's task force. If the strike attacks from a different zone, the carrier CAP is not involved.

BTW, I also understand that the interception for carrier planes is automatic, it costs no operation points, simply when an enemy strike goes through its zone, this "interception" is triggered.

Yes that's right.

Bombing with Soviets?

1/Let's concentrate on the backfires. They have black missiles. I had assumed they have bomb steps too . But now I'm not sure

So do they have bombs and can I choose between their use

2/in section 17 it says that you must use missiles unless it's against troops refers to section 17.4. Which is for attacking soviet troops. Am I right in assuming that this only applies to NATO . Or does it also apply to the soviets

3/. The player aid card. Has a drm on cruise missiles against troops. But not for bombs

So it seems you can use missiles for troops. So how does that square off with comment in 2

Hi - the basic idea here is that the Soviets have to use their missiles so they cannot, for example, use bombs against the German airfields - they have to use their missiles instead.

While the *player* may want the attack to be devastating, a realistic military planner would use the weapons available that also give the aircrew the best chance of coming home.

The Soviets can use bombs if they attack troops, though I'm not sure that's actually possible for the Soviets - I'd have to pore over the rules but I cannot remember anywhere that it would be possible.

It was more of a 'series rule' so that I make sure to carry this over for future games. It created issues with player knowledge - you can see the enemy has no fighters, but a real mission planner would be more cautious, so I just took it out rather than wrestle with it. Otherwise we had entire divisions of badgers bombing on 6 dice..

(Also, the NATO SAMs are not represented in game because of Soviet missile range advantage - it would have required adding in a whole ton of SAM systems and 'over Germany' NATO fighters. Ultimately, the Soviets would have not been much better off as it's so much more dangerous.

Rebasing of planes:

1. When do air units return to base? Is it directly after a mission or will they linger after, for example, an asw search? Will a FTR return to base after an interception or will it remain On patrol?

2. Can planes be intercepted when returning to base?

#1 - right after completing their mission.

FTR remain on patrol (they haven't yet completed their mission and will remain on patrol indefinitely)

#2 No

Nota bene, rebasing is only allowed through card play so landing at another airbase is not relevant. Aircrafts always return to the airbase of origin.

1. Repaired capital ship will return to major port where it entered?

**2. To destroy target markers(via events) what damage point needed?
normal hit or collateral hit?**

3. NATO sub which has save ability can not count Soviet Shkval?

**4. If all surface ships are eliminated only escort sub is remaining
remove TF marker and put that sub out. correct or not?**

**5. While the carrier is in the port it's FTR can do CAP against
STK attacking that port?**

1) Yes, makes sense.

2) Hit points of target markets is indicated on the counter. Collateral is for troops, so normal damage.

3) The expression in the rules "causing a step loss" is used elsewhere in the rules where save rolls are allowed so guess it is not different here. Thus a save roll is allowed even vs Shkval.

4) Correct, sub is left in the zone the TF previously occupied.

5) I had intended (I think.. memory is hazy) that CAP could still fly if a carrier was in port, otherwise the carrier is too vulnerable. Certainly they would rebase to a nearby airfield as you say.

Overflight:

Say the Danish and Southern Europe War Tracks are in their at start positions. Are Danish and Turkish on map fighters allowed to roll the full 3 dice allowance against an overflying strike composed of only 1 or 2 air units? Or are they subject to the limit of rules 17.6 and 17.7 like "normal" air units?

Yes, 3 dice allowed. The restriction you are referring to is the number of a/c allowed to fight not the number of dice.

Intrinsic Maritime Patrols:

What happens to Intrinsic Maritime Patrol when they suffer from a step loss in Fighter vs Maritime Patrol Combat?

They are just prevented from detecting, don't worry about casualties and so on - being blind is bad enough.

Escorts:

Can escort FTRs come from a different base to the STR a/c they are escorting?

e.g. Buccaneers from UK attacking TF next to Iceland...can the F15s from Iceland escort them?

No if extrapolating the reasoning in 16.3.3 they would count as separate flights. And I guess a rendez-vous in air might not be that easy, although my knowledge in that matter is very restricted.

Put the Keflavik F-15 On Patrol before the strike instead?

No, I disallowed any of that stuff, even though it could happen because it's really quite hard to do even for well trained and experienced crews and also it keeps things simpler.

If an escorted strike is intercepted by CAP in a sea zone en route to the target and combat occurs between an escort and CAP, does the escort which engaged in combat proceed to the target after combat or does it return to base?

Example; USN strike craft is escorted by F-14 headed toward Kola. A Yak 38 on CAP from the Minsk engages the strike as it passes through The Barrents Sea. The Yak is destroyed. The strike is now detected. Does the F-14 continue to target or is it returned to base spent?

Carrier CAP only intercepts if someone exits their zone - so in your example the Yak is not eligible to intercept but it could be used for CAP because of the next rule.

Other than that they fly CAP if their TF is attacked or a base in their zone is attacked.

Escorts do not return to base after fighting, they can fight again.

Tankers:

2.1.4 Soviet Tanker Aircraft (TKR) says the Soviet player begins with 2 Tanker Aircraft added to their force to increase the ranges of Strike and Fighter aircraft and refers to 13.1. But 13.1 Soviet Tanker units says the Soviet player has Tanker units which can extend the range of land-based Strike aircraft. So can Fighters use Tanker aircraft? If not, can Fighters with zero range do anything but fly CAP over their own base?

Tankers - really should only be able to fuel STK aircraft - most soviet fighters lacked in-flight refueling capability.

Spent CAP:

Under what circumstances will a carrier CAP be spent?

Pretty much only if it flies an escort mission - in other words it's no longer really on CAP - most of the squadron is elsewhere or rearming/refueling after having flown.

Declining fighter vs fighter combat, or flying a combat mission (such as escorting a strike package)

Air-to-Air Combat:

In the case with three fighters vs. one fighter, how is the combat resolved? One plane vs. one, three vs. one or three vs. three?

One vs One.

When the number is not the same:

Fighter vs strike: "Roll all Fighter dice with one fighter for each strike unit."

17.7.4 Fighter vs. Escorted Air Strike

"Resolve exactly as for Fighter vs Fighter combat, but the nonstriking player may roll with a number of fighters equal to the number of enemy Strike or Fighter units"

Only for sure. When the attack units are more than the CAP units, this excess units not are engaged in combat. Right?

Yes, this is correct.

What is the reason for limiting the attacker's fighter capabilities by NOT allowing him to use his numerical advantage?

The rationale is that a smaller strike is more difficult to detect in the first place.

Initially, I had a detection number for a FTR to respond at all, modified by what was actually happening. A very large strike was almost automatically detected whereas a very small strike flying anti-RADAR (Buccaneers at 30 feet over a forest, in the dark) was very hard to detect and respond to.

This was a simplification of that idea which requires less thought and one less table.

And, since you're going to choose your best unit to attack with, you effectively already get a DRM bonus - sneaking up on a load of MIG-31 is not so easy with 4 dice at +2; whereas a poor old MIG-21 is more likely to be killed on the ground.

Submarine questions:

Short Range vs. Long Range attacks with submarine missiles

17.13 Submarine Launched Missiles:

Roll one die, applying modifiers to determine the results

1-3 No attack
4-7 Long Range
8-9 Short Range
10+ Short and Torpedo

Long Range: Resolve a missile attack with the amount of missiles

Short Range: Resolve a missile attack with the amount of missiles

My Question:

I can't find any further reference with "Long Range" or "Short Range"

I presume there is a table or something which refers how to conduct the long range and or short range but I can't find them !

"Short range" is only modifier in SAM Hit DRM table (positive from attacking player perspective and negative for defending player firing SAMs).

Detection of subs:

17.8 Anti-Submarine Warfare: So task forces need to be detected but not submarines, correct? It seems strange that every submarine on the map is in clear view, its location, type, and status known to the enemy at all times, and consequently can be immediately attacked. So for example NATO activates a Los Angeles sub to move two zones and attacks a Soviet Victor sub -- no prior detection required. The US sub will be guaranteed that the Soviet sub will still be there when it completes its move, and will then roll a 3d10 attack with a 63% chance of destroying or damaging the Victor with no risk of loss? Am I playing that correctly?

This is correct, if you roll the number you needed, you found it and killed it (unless it gets a save or plays a card).

On the basis of that being two full days of patrolling for 3 Los Angeles class submarines, that doesn't feel too bad - many times you will find that your invincible submarines find nothing at all.

If you are concerned with fog of war, consider that the sub counter is just the centre of reference - that submarine could be anywhere within 1000 miles of that point, because it can move two zones and attack.

Hydrophone barriers:

6.8 Hydrophone Barriers

This needs a FRESH friendly unit to use one of the options.

Task forces can never use this rule however, nor anything in a task force - escort subs are too busy escorting their friends.

Detecting Task Forces with Subs:

A NATO sub is attempting to attack an undetected Soviet Task Force.

The only option seems to to use 17.8 Anti-Submarine Warfare.

Essentially the submarine moves into to Sea Zone, rolls it's die and on natural 10s gets a poor detection on the Task Force.

It can then do a 17.12 Missile Attack on the Task Force.

The only way a sub can attack an undetected TF is via natural 10 roll during an ASW attack yes - though generally it's on from 1-3 dice, depending on the unit.

Missile coordination:

17.13 Submarine Launched Missiles when done by a Missile Coordination action: Imagine we have 3 Echo II coordinating to attack a good detected TF.

- Do they roll 2 dice per Sub (1 base + 1 good detection)?
- The first two dice with no DRM, the next two with a -2 and the last two with a -4?
- Or all 6 dice with -4 DRM?

17.13: Roll one die, applying modifiers and use the best die rolled to determine the result.

So one die, plus one die if you have a good detection. Then apply the modifiers (-4 for 3 subs coordinating). You need a modified value on either die of 4 to get a long-range shot.

17.20 Aircraft Bombing Missions: Only done by NATO Black missile, is that right?

17.20 NATO without green cruise missiles is always bombs yes.
and (17.19): Any Strike unit with missiles must use them when attacking unless attacking troops' [17.24].

17.20 Aircraft Bombing Missions: *Once all air transit and CAP attacks have been resolved, air Strike units can resolve their attack.*

That's also true for 17.21 "Cruise Missile Attacks", right?

17.20 Cruise missiles don't have to run the gauntlet of interceptors and CAP, they can only be effected by SAMs. Their carrying platform could be shot down though before launching yes.

17.20: Bombing: *If splitting between targets in the same zone, split before rolling any. Example: A US CAG attacking the Kola Peninsula may allocate one die to attack the airfields and another die to attack the ports.*

I don't understand well the Air Strike missions. You can choose in the same operation any number of Strike units, and form groups to attack more than one facility (even in different places)?

17.20 bombing: you fly your strike to one location, and then if the target is a land base you may allocate dice between multiple targets if they exist, like up in Kola - where you can fly to North 9-10 and attack both the Soviet ports and airfields at the same time.

17.22 Collateral Damage causes step losses to units at or flying from the airbase or port under attack.

The step losses can be applied to Capital Ships too, right? And, in that case, they follow the capital ship damage procedure, right?

yes all targets are fair game, and yes they would resolve on the capital damage process. it is dangerous to be in port getting shot at.

Submarine warfare:

If a submarine rolls a N10 (torpedoes, not the doubles generated missile attack) does this hit take effect immediately or can it be removed by a successful ASW roll of 8+?

Yes it can be cancelled.

I have a doubt. The 8+ coming from TF ASW can be used to removed torpedo hits. But is this opportunity allowed in addition or in place of hitting submarines?

For example, 1 sub makes 2 hits on the TF but this one managed to have a 9 which is enough to hit the submarine. So, it is TF owner allowed to hit the submarine and to remove 1 hit from sub or should he make a choice between 1 sub hit removed or 1 hit on the sub?

17.11: In addition to causing hits

Invasion, Amphibious Landings and Location specific questions:

In section 20.0 the advance of the Invasion track is based on a comparison with the "Troops Needed" value. If two Soviet troops are one hex from Oslo, and one NATO troop is in Oslo, what happens ? The two Soviet troops advance in Oslo ("Troops Needed" value = 2), and then one Soviet troop and the NATO troop are removed ?

There cannot be both NATO and Soviet troops on the track - each NATO troop must be removed by a Soviet troop which is also removed before checking for advances.

NATO troops have no location, they are there only to cancel Soviet troops

Amphibious Landings:

What happens to the Amphib units after a landing in Bodo? Do they need to sail back to Kola, or do the teleport back a few turns later?

Just take it off - its done the job

Invasion tracks:

I am wondering what happens if the Soviet troops are removed from the middle of any invasion track. 1) Should I mark its last position with something other than Soviet troop marker? 2) what if Soviet lands enough troops later? will they progress from the last point they occupied?

For example, let's say there is one Soviet troop in the middle of the Denmark invasion war track. Suppose NATO has delivered two troops at the invasion track later. Up to my understanding, one NATO and one Soviet troops should be removed from the track one-to-one basis as per rule 18.3 and one NATO troop remains.

Yes, mark the last position - if you land more troops you pickup where you left off.

I can't seem to get Norway straight. Soviets start with one troop on the invasion track and one more coming in turn 3. But they can also invade at two separate locations using ambhibs. Won't this mean that some spaces would be skipped on the invasion track? What happens with those spaces and how do you "connect" the amphib force with the troops already on the track? Or have I just misunderstood the whole thing?

The troops on the invasion track move forward to the same space as the position of the amphib. So yes, a few spaces might be jumped as a result of this.

Yep a landing in effect means you have outflanked the NATO defensive position.

The Soviets invade Orland and Bodo is automatically captured. Does the Troop market already in the track (second box at the moment) advance automatically all the way to Orland?

If the Soviets manage to land in the South (Trondheim, Orland) then yes any other troops on the track are placed with the newly landed troops.

Hits on war tracks:

Hits that are placed on a track, say N. Europe, but do not have a strength of 3 or more. Are they removed at the end of the turn, or do they accumulate until they reach 3, and can stop the advance for a turn?

Removed - not enough was done to have any effect (harsh!)

Bodo:

Once Bodo is in Soviet hands, since it is in the same zone as Kola, what advantage is there in moving air units to Bodo? Dispersal to protect them?

A little of what you mention but you can also use it for example as a badger base. Other than this it can also protect Soviet troops from NATO bombing (17.24: If there is a Soviet airbase in the attacked location, fighters there fly CAP against the strike)

Iceland:

Section 19 contains the line:

"A facility always retains at least the damage it had when captured." What does that really mean?

All bases can be repaired.

the line you reference means that if it's already heavily damaged when you land then you can't make it better by landing - it's going to be heavily damaged.

You can repair it thereafter however.

Slightly related question --- USSR has captured Iceland and has 2 troops there. Can NATO bomb those troops? If so what is the effect?

All I see in the rules is bombing troops to slow advances - and of course those troops on Iceland aren't advancing

Nope, you can land your own marines but otherwise you can't harm the invading troops.

Denmark:

1. Do any Soviet troops start on the Denmark invasion track, or must they be landed there?

2. When troops land on Denmark, are they placed on the At Start box?

1. Troops must be landed in Denmark.
2. Yes they are.

Danish mines and straits:

Does the mine counter need to be taken into consideration of a Soviet Task Force if they are landing troops in Denmark

Can I land troops in Northern Norway even though the Norway track is in the South ? I have 4 troops in the Invasion track "Orland" which is in the South of Norway Track. I have already landed troops previously in Narvik. Can I land further troops in Narvik

Also I believe that I still need to do the Norway resistance. So on turn 4 I would need to roll 3 dice (-1) 2 dice.

Seems to be still strong forces considering that their capitol is just about to be overrun !

#1 - No, the mines marker is for moving through the Danish Strait.

#2 - Yes you can.

#3 yes you would need to, but you'd apply the mod for friendly troops (-2) - still MTB's ; coastal troops and whatnot around
isn't it only one die?

Striking Soviet Troops in Denmark:

To strike soviet troops in denmark NATO strike plane where should it be? baltic sea and north sea both can be possible?

Yes both

Cuba:

In the campaign, there is a MP Bear D in Cuba and there is also a card that allows the Soviet to transfert strike planes in Cuba. Is it allowed to use such planes for their usual task even if Cuba is not active or has not already been attacked by the US?

21.5 - page 35 "No Soviet air Strike units may base in Cuba while inactive, but one MP unit may base there." The MP can act as usual, though.

Smaller rules questions:

TFs in Port:

And what about a TF in an friendly port? For example, during the time the allied TF is in France facility, if the France facility is attacked by russian air strike and suffer damages, what is happening to any TF here and ships inside it? Can it suffer damages too? Can it be attacked even without a detection or is it considered to be out of the port for this purpose? And if TF is detected in the port, could it be attacked too by russian air strike as if it were in a sea zone?

They can be targeted by collateral damage and are sitting ducks. They cannot be attacked directly nor detected - but collateral hits on the port can kill them.

Concerning this, is the TF allowed to send SAM against incoming missiles targeting the port?

Nope the TF cannot shoot SAMs (it's in port, for the most part) - BUT it can use it's CAP.

Rorsats:

When you pay 2 Ops to move a RORSAT into a sea zone where there are already TFs present, do you get a free detection attempt? And a second question would be if RORSATs get attempts during the same timings as, say, a MP unit on patrol.

Nope you do not.

And no they do not.

They can detect only when ships move (but this is free once they're up)

Mines:

Are only added by cards.

Firing and ammunition spent:

When a soviet TF expend missiles to cancel amp landing effects it places a fired marker to TF?

Yes

Card questions:

Timing of cards:

Some operations event card contains 'during this card play' in case these card are played from hand(+2 ops spend) how long does it last?

Yes, this is poor wording - thankfully it only effects two cards (I believe) - It's supposed to mean 'during the day that this event is used' for example I can play *SOSUS Sabotage* on day one but not trigger the event until day two. When I do this, it lasts all of day two (but you lost the element of surprise)

NATO card 18 - Operations event

"apply -1 to Soviet stability" is synonymous with "stability one right."

Is it correct?

Yes, down the track 1 box towards coup

Card No. 39 Paratroops:

Regarding the Soviet card "Paratroops, what is the Facility Damage stats of an airbase placed in Malta or Crete, 1/2?

Yep 1/2.

Are there any markers to be placed on map as a reminder that Crete/Malta becomes Soviet airbase?

Use one of the Soviet airbase counters.

Card 55:

I don't understand how to play this "Strike Strategic Targets" card.

It says "place 2 Target markers", what is a target marker?

Then it says "these can be attacked", how?

What exactly is attacking what? How many dice am I rolling and what am I trying to roll? Any help appreciated.

Hi Gamer,

for #55 NATO: *Strike Strategic Targets (Sevastopol)*

Place 2 target markers near Sevastopol. These can be attacked for the following effects...

The two markers are:

Nuclear Sites



C3 Nodes



They can be attacked by any method available to you - generally an air strike using that process, or cruise missiles using that process.

The card represents the identification of the sites as potential targets - you have to figure out how to attack them. I would suggest 3 carrier air groups for maximum damage.

Does the card stay in effect indefinitely after being placed, or do you need to attack that turn or can you get the benefits by attacking and destroying in a different turn as well.

Once on-map they are fair game thereafter.

Is a sub required to move when it performs a "move and attack" action. I am playing the first scenario and there is a NATO sub and a Soviet sub in the same sea zone, can they attack each other without actually moving? If that is a legal move, could a sub that is on patrol in the same sea zone disrupt a sub that has attacked but not moved?

You don't have to move, no.

If they don't choose to move then no, an patrol submarine cannot react.

Card No. 42 Strategic Strike:

Does the strike given by this card:

- a) have to trace a path all the way from a USSR base to the target (being subject to interceptors on the way)? or**
- b) just pick a sea zone adjacent to the target and be subject to interception there (+ CAP at the target) or**
- c) Is it only subject to CAP at the target?**

a)it still has to trace from somewhere, but with unlimited range so it should be pretty easy.

83 is just regular Soviet missiles.

85+ green missiles.

When using green trace to a zone in range of the target and fire from there. The missiles themselves cannot be attacked except by SAMs.

NATO card 55 - Operations event

"- the Soviet hand is reduced for the rest of the turn."

Is the above an exception to "A player will always have three cards."?

Yes it is

Reaction card : Submarine Prairing

Any step loss allows the play of this card.

Reaction event Distant Support

A US Carrier may commit its F-14 air unit to an air attack within one zone if any of the attacking strike is detected by an interceptor. Mark it spent afterwards."

-yes must be adjacent

-the card text doesn't say but the intent was the F-14 becomes **CAP** over the target fleet, this does require a clarification though

First Strike Card:

In soviet first strike event card 'Play before spending any points' it means this card cannot be played for day two and cannot be played from hand (+2 ops spend)?

It can be used on day two (but has to be before you spend any points) and no you cannot use the +2 cost to play it (because then you would have spent points to do so)

First Strike card, it is stated "before spending any points" so this card must always be played as the first card of the turn!! Ok?

Yes you have to play the event before you spend any ops, but it doesn't say it has to be the first card of the turn. It could perhaps have been better worded to say "Play before spending any points *from this card*"

SURTASS:

So, for example with the SURTASS event, if i apply strictly speaking the text, i can also use an already spent unit and roll the 4 dice. Ok?

No - because you are not able to mark the unit spent (it is already spent) it probably would have been better to be explicit on the card, but the rule works.

NATO Counter Attack Reaction Event:

About the Reaction Event, NATO Counter Attack, is the convoy spent (so removed) by the use of this reaction?

No the convoy is removed because it arrived at a convoy port (you get the supplies as normal) then you play this card and get the effect as well. NATO elastic defence springs back with a punch!

Card 23 - Special Forces Event

Would this attack be modified by Bad Weather?

Nope, it's just a straight roll

Scenario and setup questions:

Scenario setup and start:

Are all the subs (which are at Sea) already "On Patrol" at the start of the campaigns

I suppose this is the same question for the short scenarios

No they are not

Scenario 2 question

Scenario 2 has a British Nimrod set up in the North Sea area. Does this mean that it's on Patrol status by default? (And that its patrol is in addition to the two freebies the NATO player receives at the start of the scenario?)

Yes it's on patrol.

And yes, you also get the setup sequence.

Counter questions:

Reserve units (see First Strike Points rule where they are mentioned). The game include 3 counters for Tu22M Reserve. What do I do with them and how do I use them?

They do not start on the map. See First Strike Points rules how to use them.

What are the target markers for Cape Canaveral and Washington? How many hits does it take to destroy these targets (and other target markers)? Is it the number on the counter? The numbers on the counters are not explained in the rulebook.

They go on the board due to cards played and can be destroyed for the listed benefit (on the cards). Yes it is the number on the counter - that should have been on the QRS units sheet.

Is there a NATO missile track marker?

Apparently not. Use any of the others. (*Ed.: An idea for Paper Wars!*)

Are the Soviet dissolved TF markers used? I couldn't find a rule for dissolving Soviet TFs.

No, but they were left as I didn't have anything better to replace them with

What means the black digit in a yellow circle, found on some of the Soviet airplane counters (like Su-27)?

It's the cost of purchase as the optional/earlier production units.

Optional rules questions:

Im using opt rule 30.3 Bombs Away! which allows me to attack ships with bombs (Mavericks, Walleyes, LGB). Can I also use the SEAD rules on ships? Or are they only for ground targets?

Only ground targets.

Examples of play questions:

With regards to the examples of play in the back of the book, specifically Missiles vs a Land Target, page 53.

I'm looking at page 53, the second paragraph, second sentence. "Consulting the Soviet Missiles Table, 13 or more missiles grant three dice on the Cruise Missile Attack Table."

I had a hard time looking for the Soviet Missiles Table referenced in the above sentence, and that's because it isn't really there. What you're looking for is the **Cruise Missile**

Attacks vs. Land Targets table. It's on the ***Attacking Land Targets*** reference sheet.

The sentence below the above says Soviet missiles (ship black & yellow, all submarine, all air). And that's what you reference for the number of dice based on the number of Soviet cruise missiles launched against a Land Target.

Just thought I'd pass that along in case anyone's having trouble locating it (like I was!)

Design questions:

Is Airborne Early Warning abstracted in this game? I didn't see any AWACS, E2 Hawkeye or Mainstay counters - is this baked into the game already. Those AEW planes would be a major factor in detecting air raids and in some cases ships as well?

Yes they are baked in to each carrier counter which has detection capability within its own zone. E2 and other AWACS are baked into the various fighter counters as part of the tactical value which is predominantly the radar capability.

Why can blue missiles from surface units only be fired by card?

NATO anti ship missiles such as Exocet only had a range of about 30 nautical miles. Harpoon was better at about 50, eventually moving up to the 80 nmi range in the time of the game.

In terms of scale that's about 2 to 4 centimetres on the map, so they are really short range weapons. Plus at that range you have to get lucky not to be spotted - naval radars have ranges of about 200 miles.

Assuming no airborne radars it's still possible, but as soon as you add in airborne early warning the chance of sneaking up to this range drops way down; the aew should detect the enemy way before they get to launch range..

So that's why it's on the cards, you have to get a bit Lucky to get a shot.

Another design question I wanted to ask about: it seems as if there are no special detection rules for subs like there are for Task Forces. Did you bake their stealthiness into their defense values instead?

Yes exactly that, originally we had two rolls way back when - detection and then attack. Ultimately for ease of play it was all rolled into one roll - many Soviet subs are killed on an 8, while the US SSNs need 10's.

And many of those get a 6+ 'save' against any hit taken as well.

I do sometimes see people asking about the old 'fleet' submarine detection - but realistically, in a war scenario the only reason to detect an enemy sub is to try and sink it or avoid it - the idea of keeping a sub detected for extended periods and trailing them absolutely applies in peacetime, but in wartime you're going to setup your shot and get those fish in the water, not mess about tracking it - that's just asking for trouble.

How would you explain that an intercepting unit rolls 1 less die in an air fight? 17.6 - 17.7 thanks

Units on an interception mission are flying some 300+ nmi out to a patrol location before they even start their mission loitering, running BARCAP, etc.

With just the travel time alone, you're adding an extra ~1 1/2 hours to the mission - so less fighters will be available at any one time.

If you imagine that 1 air to air dice represents about 5 fighters doing something, then losing only one die from an average of 3 means that actually half the squadron or thereabouts is able to fight - which isn't bad.

General strategic questions (Philipp paraphrasing comments from threads and Consimworld here):

Why are my beloved (French/German/Dutch/Andorran/etc.) units so weak?

The French groups were intentionally cut down because (sorry guys) most of the ships were just reallllly poor. I instead 'built them into' convoys which is why some of the convoys have defence values like SAMs and ASW values. Also, some stuff is on port watch/patrol. This goes for 'missing' US, UK and other ships - anything that was really poor was generally pushed out the way into 'supporting' roles.

West German and Dutch may be the same, you'd have to say which ships are missing.

Don't forget that whilst it's tempting to represent everything, in reality 30% of 'stuff' is generally out of service in any moment in time - and even if only out for a short time, the game lasts one month.

Hey, what about putting huge TFs together as NATO and just duke it out with the Soviets? With enough SAM and ASW capability, those TFs are impervious?

The big 'deathstar' task forces such as described [...] above, which in game terms would have some 25 SAMs or thereabouts are a problem for the Soviets for sure.

The same rules apply, but a massive strike becomes more risky with more carriers present (though certainly you could argue more risky for both sides). The thing with the ASW rules though is that a big task force like that can still roll badly and lose a carrier (but maybe the Tico-VLS is the sweet target here). And yes, nuclear torpedoes comrades!

We did test extensively with these monster fleets and they are not impervious. But, they are hard to hurt, very scary and just melt the opponents' mind - fixation in this game is a real thing.

If you can get the best part of two divisions into them (all your naval air) with 30 missiles they can be cracked and if they go down they go down big.

Also, those VLS are very scary.. right until they run out of missiles and then they are worthless - I've seen more than a few empty VLS's in bad positions.